# Private bank cards: who's winning?

1

## Federal and IDFC First add cards fastest

HDFC, the biggest, is well behind them.

2

## HDFC and ICICI shrink at shops

Kotak, Yes and Federal grow fast from small shares.

3

## IndusInd is down everywhere

On every measure in this set.

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**Swipe →**

1 · CREDIT CARDS IN FORCE

# Federal and IDFC First add cards fastest

| BANK | SHARE | AUG → SEP GROWTH | SHARE TREND | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **All private** | **70.4%** | **9.7% → 9.6%** | | |
| HDFC Bank | 21.8% | 8.3% → 8.3% | 20.2% |  |
| Axis Bank | 13.2% | 6.4% → 7.3% | 13.8% |  |
| ICICI Bank | 15.9% | 9.1% → 8.1% | 16.9% |  |
| Kotak | 3.9% | 6.5% → 7.3% | 6.0% |  |
| IDFC First | 4.0% | 25.2% → 23.7% | 2.4% |  |
| Yes Bank | 2.5% | 18.0% → 17.7% | 1.9% |  |
| RBL Bank | 3.8% | 3.3% → 2.9% | 5.1% |  |
| IndusInd | 2.4% | −6.6% → −6.5% | 2.8% |  |
| **Federal Bank** | **2.2%** | **81.8% → 75.0%** | 0.9% |  |

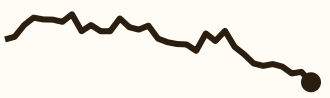
**September alone: Federal Bank 81.8% to 75.0%, still the fastest. ICICI 9.1% to 8.1%.**

indiacreditlens.com

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2 · CREDIT CARD VALUE AT SHOPS

# HDFC still leads, and it's shrinking

| BANK | SHARE | AUG → SEP GROWTH | SHARE TREND | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **All private** | **72.7%** | **4.2% → 1.4%** | | |
| **HDFC Bank** | **26.5%** | **0.9% → −6.7%** | 26.9% |  |
| Axis Bank | 15.5% | 11.6% → 15.7% | 14.8% |  |
| ICICI Bank | 11.4% | −5.1% → −9.2% | 14.2% |  |
| Kotak | 4.3% | 39.4% → 35.8% | 4.3% |  |
| IDFC First | 3.7% | 30.2% → 26.8% | 2.2% |  |
| Yes Bank | 3.6% | 42.3% → 41.6% | 1.9% |  |
| RBL Bank | 3.2% | 3.7% → 3.9% | 5.8% |  |
| IndusInd | 2.2% | −47.7% → −42.8% | 3.6% |  |
| Federal Bank | 1.5% | 44.4% → 40.7% | 0.9% |  |

○ A one-month share jump of 2+ points: HDFC Bank Dec 25; Axis Bank Oct 24; IndusInd Sep 24.

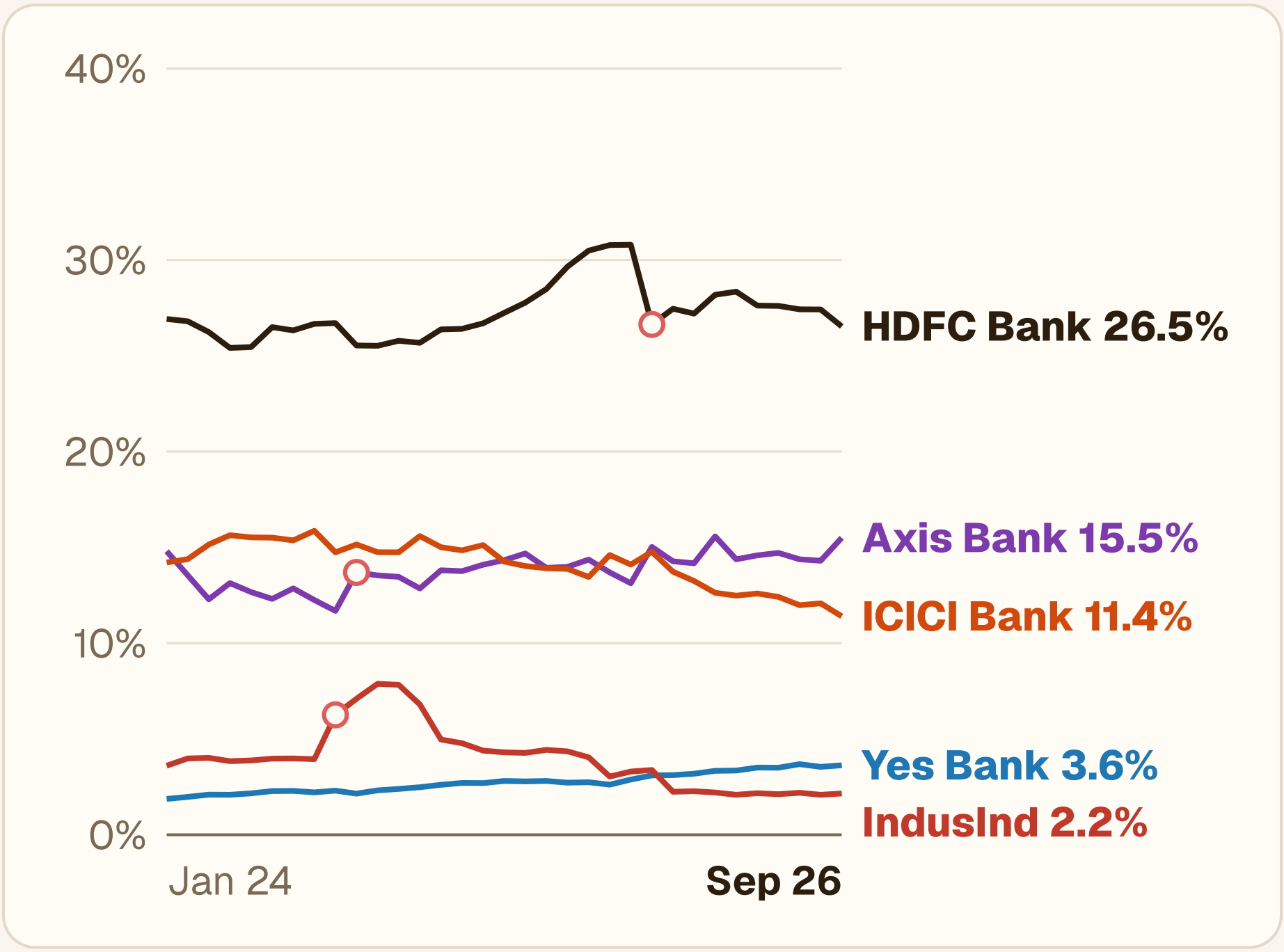
**September alone: HDFC 0.9% to −6.7%, on a high base: it grew 36.1% a year ago.**



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3 · SHARE OF CARD VALUE AT SHOPS

# Since Jan 2024: ICICI and IndusInd slip, Yes Bank climbs




**HDFC's big step was one month: 30.8% to 26.6% in Dec 2025 (circled). September alone: 27.4% to 26.5%.**



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4 · SWIPES VS VALUE AT SHOPS

# HDFC: swipes up, rupees down

| BANK | SWIPES | VALUE | SWIPE SHARE | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **All private** | **21.6%** | **1.4%** | | |
| **HDFC Bank** | **17.7%** | **–6.7%** | 30.5% |  |
| Axis Bank | 29.0% | 15.7% | 17.1% |  |
| ICICI Bank | –6.2% | –9.2% | 11.2% |  |
| Kotak | 53.2% | 35.8% | 5.7% |  |
| IDFC First | 30.7% | 26.8% | 3.0% |  |
| Yes Bank | 45.7% | 41.6% | 2.4% |  |
| RBL Bank | –8.4% | 3.9% | 4.2% |  |
| IndusInd | –40.3% | –42.8% | 2.3% |  |
| Federal Bank | 39.4% | 40.7% | 1.0% |  |

**September alone: HDFC's swipes 19.2% to 17.7%, value 0.9% to –6.7%.**

5 · CREDIT CARD VALUE ONLINE

# Online value fell. HDFC's didn't

| BANK | SHARE | AUG → SEP GROWTH | SHARE TREND | |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **All private** | **74.5%** | **3.4% → −10.4%** | | |
| **HDFC Bank** | **35.3%** | **22.5% → 15.7%** | 25.9% |  |
| Axis Bank | 8.8% | 0.8% → −29.0% | 10.8% |  |
| ICICI Bank | 17.5% | −6.7% → −31.4% | 19.8% |  |
| Kotak | 2.7% | 6.2% → −7.4% | 3.5% |  |
| IDFC First | 1.4% | −0.1% → −11.3% | 1.3% |  |
| Yes Bank | 1.1% | −13.5% → −15.0% | 1.2% |  |
| RBL Bank | 3.6% | −0.3% → 1.1% | 3.4% |  |
| IndusInd | 2.5% | −50.5% → −39.8% | 5.2% |  |
| Federal Bank | 1.3% | 51.2% → 47.4% | 1.0% |  |

○ A one-month share jump of 2+ points: HDFC Bank Sep 24, Oct 24, Dec 24, Aug 26, Sep 26; Axis Bank Oct 24.

**September alone: private banks 3.4% to −10.4%. A high base: ICICI grew 43.0% a year ago.**



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# Terminals and QR codes: read with care

| BANK | POS SHARE | POS GROWTH | QR SHARE | QR GROWTH |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **All private** | **79.6%** | **–18.5%** | **96.4%** | **25.5%** |
| HDFC Bank | 19.2% | 16.3% | 0.1% | 28.9% |
| Axis Bank | 26.3% | 13.8% | 21.9% | 71.9% |
| ICICI Bank | 1.8% | –91.6% | 0.4% | 1.1% |
| Yes Bank | 2.1% | 116.0% | 72.1% | 16.8% |
| RBL Bank | 26.8% | –15.7% | 0.0% | –4.1% |

One-month jumps: POS terminals, June 2026 (ICICI, Axis, RBL, HDFC). UPI QR, Sep 2026 (Axis, Yes).

## Real shift or a change in reporting? If you work on cards at one of these banks, what am I missing?

> **September alone: Axis's QR growth 18.1% to 71.9%. Its POS growth 6.3% to 13.8%.**